Tibet and common boundary between Tibet and India'. He asked Panikkar to give some indication to the Chinese side (before he officially returned to India since he was no longer recognized as Indian envoy by the new regime) of India's willingness to settle matters of common interest through diplomatic negotiation. [11] This suggested that up until September 1949, Nehru was looking at achieving outcomes through the process of diplomatic negotiations.

Things began to change from 1 October 1949, after Mao Zedong proclaimed the formal establishment of the People's Republic of China. Immediately upon his return to India, Panikkar began pressing upon the Government of India for early recognition of the new Chinese regime. Nehru recorded a note to the Ministry of External Affairs on 17 November 1949 in which he said that 'both Panikkar and Stevenson are anxious that recognition should be given as early as possible. They think that delay may be injurious'. [12]

However, there were other influential voices in the Government of India that advocated patience in this respect. Chief among them was India's Deputy Prime Minister Vallabhbhai Patel, who felt there was nothing to be gained by early recognition. Panikkar, in his memoirs, mentioned that the Governor General of India, C. Rajagopalachari, had joined Patel in urging Nehru to go slow in the matter. [13] Why were such voices of advice ignored?

For one, the formal establishment of the new regime in China may have hastened consideration of diplomatic recognition. Nehru, and the Government of India, may possibly have seen this as a historic opportunity to stand, as it were, on the right side of history with regard to the Chinese Revolution, which Nehru considered 'a world event of the first magnitude'. [14] Early recognition might also have been seen as being helpful in achieving Nehru's vision of India and China working in